

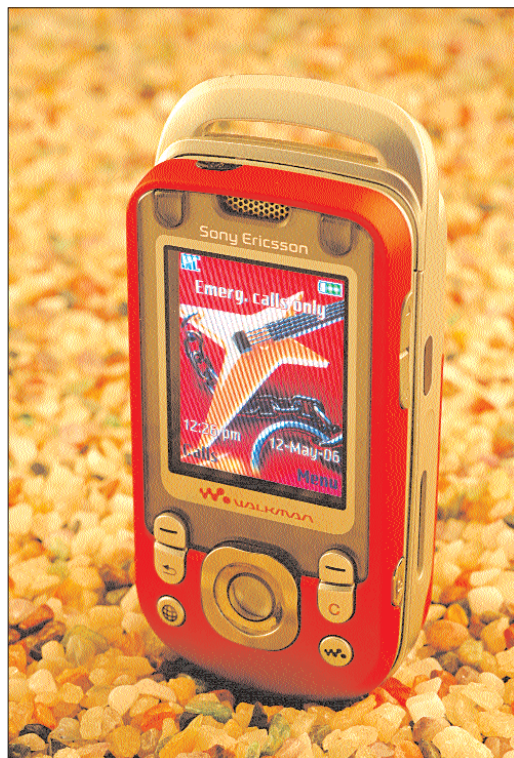
Coming to multimedia playback, the 7360 loses out big time due to lack of expandability. MP3 playback was decent however, with the 6600 and E398 offering similar music and viewing capabilities. Almost all the phones in this category—even the ones in the next price bracket—play both MP3 and AAC files, so it's just overall music playback quality we tested. As far as video playback goes, 3GP is the format of choice of format for cells. Why? Because the format is resource easy, is free and small in terms of file size, therefore video quality tests were done in 3GP format. Nothing much to report on the music and video front, as all these cells are more or less similar in terms of quality of content playback offered.

In terms of productivity, the Nokia 6600 offers the ability to view MS Word, Excel and PowerPoint documents, ditto the 6270, the E398 misses out here. As far as editing existing office documents go, none of these phones will allow the user to do any writing or spreadsheet work. Even the other Symbian cell phones have been designed to allow reading only.

One problem with the Nokia 6600, which deserves a mention, is its slow processor, one of the slowest across all the categories of phones tested. Using a large capacity memory card will only aggravate this, and video playback can get a little choppy. This is one cell that could use more processing power.

Rs 12,000 to Rs 15,000

Moving up the price ladder a bit, we have a fairly decent number of phones priced between Rs 12,000 and Rs 15,000. These phones represent what the discerning user will actually look at. We were also a stricter as far as music and camera quality are concerned, simply because a costlier phone, while not comparable to a



Photograph: Anurag Pathi

The Sony Ericsson W550i—Looks good, sounds better

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